

Littlefield Gains Fourth Win In Nailing Bears in Opener

Wichita Unlocks 5-5 Tie with Run
In Eighth for Nightcap Triumph

By PETE LIGHTNER
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The Braves sent the American Association race into a dizzy whirl by copping two games from the league-leading Denver Bears Sunday at Lawrence Field. The scores were 5 to 0 and 6 to 5 and thereby reducing the Denver edge to a mere one-half a game.

The largest Sunday turnout of the season (2,378) saw just about the best baseball entertainment, from the Wichita angle, of the 1958 season.

The first one was fairly easy, with Dick Littlefield hurling a shutout for his fourth straight victory.

But that second one had everything in it but a balk.

Teams Muff Chances

And with both teams having chance after chance to rip it wide open in the late frames (and missing) it took a little dribbling ground ball, which Curt Hardaway (the Bears) let get through his hands, to provide the winning run for the Braves in the eighth.

Wichita had blown a 5-run lead, which the Braves piled up in the first four. The Braves had three times flubbed golden chances to provide a good cushion, twice failing to score after loading the bases with one out and another time after leading off with a walk and a single.

Denver, driving Don Kaiser out in the fifth, with John Blanchard's three-run homer against the scoreboard the finishing blow, came up to a 5-4 score. Then in the top of the eighth tied it, 5-5 when pinch hitter Vern Rapp socked a single which scored Dick Sanders from second base.

Braves Finally Win

But the Braves won it, for Juan Pizarro, who copped his second victory in two nights, in the last of the eighth.

With two out Joe Koppe blasted a mighty triple up against the left-center wall.

Casey Wise drew a walk off John Kucab, third Denver hurler. Then ensued the inevitable

battle of wits, Denver Manager Andy Cohen called in a southpaw, Jack McMahan and Ben Geraghty called in a pinch-hitter Bib Talbot, for Ed Haas.

Talbot sent a harmless looking dribbler toward third, and Hardaway, charging the ball in haste for a play, let it ooze through and Koppe raced home with what proved to be the winning run.

Pizarro had fanned the same Hardaway in the top of the eighth, to pull the Braves out. Juan relieved Dave Jolly, who had let in the tying run.

Braves Start Good

Wichita started ahead, in the second, getting a run on a hit batsman, Earl Hersh who got a nasty crack on the elbow from starter Mark Freeman, Ray Shearer's single, and an error in right.

Hersh came right back strong in the next frame and his homer with Haas on base climaxed a three run rally. It all came about with two out. Wise starting it off with a single. Haas getting a triple to left and Hersh the homer.

Kaiser, starting Brave, singled in the fifth Wichita run in the fourth but couldn't hold his big advantage.

Wise hit into a double play in the same inning with one out and the bases full. In the next frame, Wichita left three on, loading the bases with one out. But Al Spangler popped to the catcher and Mike Roarke forced Ed Charles to end that one.

Denver, in the meantime, was also threatening and actually had what seemed to be the tying run over in the sixth, but lost it on a ground rule. Gordie Windhorn led off with a hit, and Sanders beat one out, after bunting the ball. Roarke threw wide to first base, the ball scampering into the Denver bullpen, and Windhorn came in.

But Umpires Doyle and Carabba sent Windhorn back to third and Sanders to second, much to the indignation of Andy Cohen who stormed to no avail.

It was, truthfully, a lucky break, for Jolly put on the brakes, got Brickell out on a pop up, fanned a pinch hitter and then got the leadoff man, Gene Hassell on another pop up, to short.

The Bears got one on in the ninth, with one out but Pizarro poured that fast one across and made the finish himself, when he took Windhorn's roller, ran to the line and tagged out the Bear, very vigorously.

Charleston Annexes Two

CHARLESTON, W. VA., June 22 (AP) — Charleston swept a Sunday doubleheader from the St. Paul Saints, 6-0 and 3-2, before 3,772 fans. Jerry Davie pitched a four-hitter in the shutout opener. The 24-year-old righthander won his eighth game against no losses, registered his fourth shutout, and has allowed only three runs in his last 45 innings of pitching.

ST. PAUL		R	H	RBI
Curry ss	4	0	1	0
Williams 2b	4	0	1	0
Wilson rf	4	0	0	0
Demeter cf	2	0	0	0
Hawes 1b	2	0	0	0
Spears 3b	3	0	0	0
Montemayor lf	3	0	1	0
Worley c	3	0	0	0
Nesray p	2	0	0	0
Stabiner p	1	0	0	0
Totals	28	0	4	0
CHARLESTON		R	H	RBI
Terwilliger 2b	4	0	1	1
Delaine cf	3	1	2	1
Skizas 3b	4	1	0	1
Taylor lf	3	0	1	1
Osborne 1b	4	0	1	1
Walters rf	4	0	0	0
Shantz	4	1	1	0
Saunder ss	4	2	4	0
Davie p	3	1	1	0
Totals	33	6	11	5
St. Paul	000	000	000	0
Charleston	001	000	100	4

GAME NOTES. The Bears and Braves fly west this morning, to open a 4-game series at Denver. Don Nottebart will hurl for Wichita. Denver's choice, Ed Donnelly, hurled in both games Sunday and is out of it, so a new hurler, named McLain, may start.—The win gave Wichita five wins and Denver six, in this season's games the Bears and Braves have played.—Ray Shearer had a great night, getting three singles and two doubles. Hersh got his eighth homer of the year.—Casey Wise got a big hand by making an impossible stop off Blanchard in the second game, but missing the put-out at first by a whisker, the ball being hit away over the second bag.—The Braves return home a week from today, to start a big home stand, with a Fourth double header.